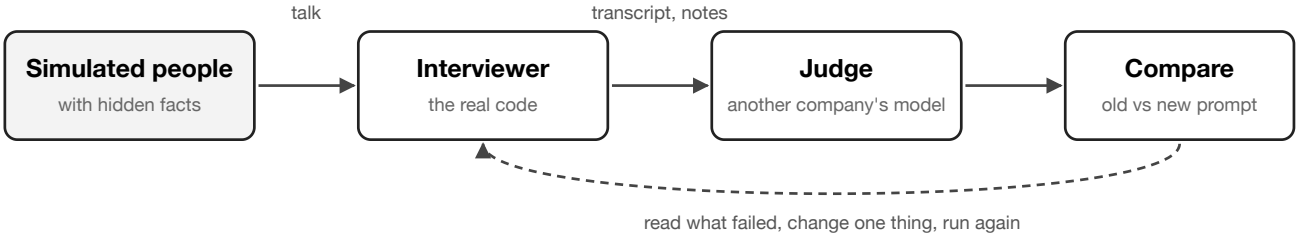
How the Viven interviewer is tested

Utkarsh Kanwat · November 2026 · eval/ in the repo

Real conversations can't show what was missed, because nobody knows what the person could have said. So the real interviewer talks to simulated people whose facts I wrote down first, and every prompt change is scored on how many came out and what else got worse.



1 The test set

Simulated people	**10** (5 tune, 5 held back)
Hidden facts	**104** (56 important)
… shared freely	11
… only if asked	37
… only if probed	34
… only once they trust you	22
Outsider questions + answers	**51**
Answers per run	12, "call me later" after 6

From a retired principal and a Hinglish-speaking grandmother to a wary ICU nurse and a farmer slow to trust. They get annoyed and can walk out.

2 What gets scored

Score	Meaning
Twin test	outsider questions answered right from notes alone (main score)
Facts said	hidden facts the person said
Facts saved	hidden facts that reached the notes
Areas covered	parts of their life the notes cover
Guards	walk-outs, annoyance, re-asks, double questions, praise, pushing after a no, unsupported notes, made-up answers. None may get worse.

3 Rounds that changed the design

Change	Score	Before	After
Notes as a folder tree	facts drawn out	0.12	**0.23**
	important facts	0.08	**0.18**
	vs plain baseline	0.18	**0.23**
Voice model leads	reply time	2.4–7.8 s	**0.9–1.5 s**
One-question opener	two-part questions	32%	**16%**
	single openers	0 / 5	**10 / 10**

Baseline: same model, one sensible prompt. My first design lost to it by digging into one topic.

4 Latest round, by how hard the fact was

Facts said	Before	After
shared freely	1.00	1.00
only if asked	0.12	**0.19**
only if probed	0.34	0.34
only once they trust you	0.05	**0.09**
all facts	0.28	**0.32**
areas of life covered	2.0	**2.8**
re-asks per conversation (guard)	0.2	**0.5 ✗**

10 conversations per side, graded blind. Trust facts are the biggest gap. The guard caught re-asks going up.

5 How much to trust these numbers

Different judge	From a different company than the interviewer, so it isn't grading its own kind of writing.
Ranges, not single numbers	Same people and seeds on both sides. With 5 people per side, small changes come out "can't tell".
Held-back people	Changes come from failures on 5 people and count only if they help the other 5. Not run yet: the credit ran out.
Checking the judge	Graded twice to see how often labels flip; my marks vs the judge's on a review page. My marks aren't done yet.
Real conversations	No answer key: the judge writes likely outsider questions, answers them from the notes, checks against the transcript.

Run with node eval/run.ts (sim, grade, compare, view, meta). Grading is cached, so regrading old runs costs nothing. Every round is written up in THINKING.md.